

Hello

And welcome to the second edition of NABI. Get ready for an exciting journey through the realms of art, culture, and creativity. I'll be your curator, guiding you through the vibrant landscapes of art, the great outdoors, and entertainment.

I hope you enjoy!

-Olivia Turner

Blurring Boundaries:Huang Po Hsun's Art



Huang Po Hsun Water Dessert Shop, Acrylic, 47x76 cm, 2023

In Chen, Kuang-Yi's article "LUXE, CALME ET VOLUPTÉ – THE DAILY NARRATION OF HUANG PO HSUN," we dive into the world of a Taiwanese artist whose works resonate with themes of loneliness, abundance, and the blending of high and low art forms. Huang Po Hsun's journey through various cities in Taiwan and his immersion in subcultures like otaku and doujinshi culture have deeply influenced his artistry, evident in his paintings' vibrant colors and intricate shapes.

Chen's article draws attention to the transition of subcultures like anime, comics, and games into contemporary art, highlighting exhibitions that blur the lines between high and low art. This transition mirrors Huang Po Hsun's artistic evolution, as he infuses elements of ACG (anime, comics, games) into his work, creating a unique blend of high art skills with pop culture aesthetics.

One of the striking aspects of Huang Po Hsun's art is its decorative nature, reminiscent of the decorative arts movement that sought to blur the boundaries between fine art and craft. His use of flat painting skills, simplified shapes, and intricate patterns reflects a desire to create art that is not only visually appealing but also carries narrative depth.

Huang Po Hsun's works serve as visual storytellers, often inspired by literary works and personal experiences. His series, such as "The Light and the Dive of a Fighting Fish" and "The Forest of Babel," transport viewers to imaginative worlds filled with symbolism and poetic imagery. These narratives, combined with his decorative style, offer viewers comfort and contemplation, echoing Henri Matisse's concept of "luxe calme et volupté."

Through Chen's exploration of Huang Po Hsun's art, we gain a deeper understanding of the artist's influences and intentions. His art becomes not just a visual experience but a narrative journey that invites viewers to explore their own emotions and memories.

Springtime Blooms: A Crochet Flower Tutorial

Looking for a quick and easy crochet project? These spring flowers are perfect for you! Once you get the hang of it, each flower only takes a few minutes to make. Use them to create a canvas, wreath, or garland, or incorporate them into other craft projects. Plus, they're a great way to use up leftover yarn!

Materials Needed:
- Cotton yarn in 2 colors
- 3 mm crochet hook (or size suitable for the yarn)

Stitches Used:
- sl st (slip stitch)
- ch (chain)
- dc (double crochet)
- st (stitch)

Pattern:

Round 1:
- Start with the color you want for the center of the flower. Make a magic ring.
- Ch 2 (counts as 1 dc), work 11 dc into the ring. Join with a sl st in the 2nd ch. (12 sts) Cut yarn.

Round 2:
- Change to the color you want for the petals. Attach yarn in any st with a sl st.
- Ch 2 (counts as 1 dc), work 1 dc in the same st, 2 dc in the next st 11 times. Join with a sl st in the 2nd ch. (24 sts)

Round 3:
- Ch 2 (counts as 1 dc), work 2 dc in the same st, skip 1 st, 1 sl st, skip 1 st, 6 dc in the same st, skip 1 st, 1 sl st, skip 1 st 5 times. End with 3 dc in the same st as the first 3 dc. Join with a sl st in the 2nd ch. (6 petals).



A Timeless Masterpiece: Exploring Life and Immortality in *Frieren: Beyond Journey's End*



I recently had the pleasure of watching "Frieren: Beyond Journey's End," which left a lasting impression on me. This anime is a true masterpiece, skillfully weaving together a narrative that not only entertains but also delves into profound emotional experiences, all while being one of the best-animated shows from the Winter 2024 season.

The anime follows the story of Frieren, an elven mage who was part of a legendary group of adventurers that defeated the Demon King and restored peace to the world. The series explores Frieren's life after the quest, highlighting her long lifespan and the impact it has on her relationships with her short-lived companions, who age and eventually pass away while she remains unchanged. The anime delves into themes of friendship, regret, and the passage of time, offering a unique perspective on the hero's journey and the meaning of immortality.

One of the aspects of the series that I found most compelling was its portrayal of time and the lifespan of the main character, Frieren. Through clever use of flashbacks and storytelling, the anime manages to capture the grandeur of Frieren's long life, showing us snippets of her experiences that span entire lifetimes of other characters. This unique approach adds depth to the story and invites viewers to contemplate the nature of time and existence.

Furthermore, the character development in the show is exceptional. Frieren, in particular, undergoes a profound transformation throughout the series, from a somewhat aloof and detached individual to someone who deeply cares about her companions and their journeys. Her evolution is both heartwarming and relatable, reminding us of the importance of connections and relationships in our own lives.

The animation and art style is nothing short of stunning. The detailed character designs and beautiful backgrounds create a visually captivating world that draws viewers in from the first episode. The use of color and lighting effectively sets the mood for each scene, whether it's a peaceful moment of reflection or an intense battle sequence.

One of the standout aspects of the animation is its ability to convey the passage of time. As Frieren and her companions age and the world around them changes, subtle visual cues and character design changes help illustrate the effects of time on the characters and their environment. This attention to detail adds a layer of realism to the story and enhances the overall viewing experience.

Overall, "Frieren: Beyond Journey's End" is a true gem of an anime that I believe will be remembered as a classic in years to come. I highly recommend it to anyone looking for a thought-provoking and emotionally engaging story.